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Главная / Новости



Открытие месторождения чистого никеля в Нью-Гэмпшире поставило в тупик финансирование горнодобывающих проектов на начальном этапе

Компания First Atlantic Nickel, работающая над технико-экономическим обоснованием, заявляет, что ее готовый к выходу на рынок никель-кобальтовый сплав аваруйт не потребует плавки

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Геолог из First Atlantic Nickel исследует горную породу в офиолитовом комплексе Пайпстоун горнодобывающей компании в центральной части Ньюфаундленда. First Atlantic Nickel

Молодая горнодобывающая компания из Ванкувера заявила, что обнаружила крупное месторождение чистого никеля в центральной части Ньюфаундленда, и пытается привлечь достаточно внимания к проекту, стоимость которого, по ее оценкам, может составить 2 миллиарда долларов.

Однако First Atlantic Nickel Corp. оказалась в ситуации, с которой сталкиваются многие канадские компании, занимающиеся добычей полезных ископаемых на ранних стадиях — поиском спонсора для предоставления первоначального финансирования.



«(На этапе технико-экономического обоснования) вы начинаете претендовать на финансирование от крупных организаций, таких как канадские банки или, возможно, автопроизводители, но, очевидно, пройти этот этап непросто», — сказал Адриан Смит, генеральный директор First Atlantic Nickel.



первый никель

Образцы керна разложены на столе в кернохранилище геологов в офиолитовом комплексе Пайпстоун компании First Atlantic Nickel в центральной части Ньюфаундленда.



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В недавнем отчете, опубликованном Шазом Мерватом, директором по энергетической политике RBC, рассказывается о трудностях, с которыми сталкиваются Смит и другие начинающие предприниматели.

В ней он рассказал о том, как молодым компаниям сложно получить финансирование, необходимое для перехода от ранних стадий разведки к принятию окончательных инвестиционных решений по крупным проектам.

«Эти затраты зачастую слишком велики для состоятельных частных инвесторов и слишком рискованны для институциональных инвесторов и кредиторов, — писал Мерват [в февральском отчете](#). — Лишь немногие институциональные инвесторы исторически поддерживали канадские компании, единственным рынком сбыта для которых был китайский нефтеперерабатывающий завод, что привело к структурному дефициту финансирования, из-за которого перспективные проекты годами оставались нереализованными».

В докладе отмечается, что нехватка финансирования «замедляет» рост канадской горнодобывающей промышленности, специализирующейся на добыче критически важных полезных ископаемых.

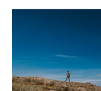
«Когда речь заходит о критически важных полезных ископаемых, Канада по большей части остается юрисдикцией, ориентированной на добычу и транспортировку. Большая часть добавленной стоимости и переработки приходится на Китай и других игроков, которые захватили сегмент переработки и развили сопутствующие цепочки поставок, такие как производство электромобилей, электроника и оборонная промышленность», — говорится в отчете.

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RBC also found that Canadian production of six core critical minerals — cobalt, nickel, lithium, copper, graphite and rare earth — currently represents only about two per cent of global supply.

According to Canadian government estimates, that production rate could grow to as much as 14 per cent if identified projects come to fruition.

first nickel

Drilling is under way at the Alloy Max Zone, a second major awaruite nickel-cobalt alloy discovery First Atlantic Nickel has found within its Pipestone Ophiolite Complex in central Newfoundland. First Atlantic Nickel

NEWFOUNDLAND NICKEL FIND

First Atlantic Nickel said its Pipestone XL property contains magnetically recoverable awaruite nickel, or clean nickel, which does not require smelting to be market-ready.

The company said it has found enough nickel for two significant open-pit mines, including one around four kilometres long and 1.2 kilometres wide.

Smith said the project would allow Newfoundland and Labrador to “export a very high-grade nickel cobalt concentrate that can go directly into the (electric vehicle) battery process in Europe and the United States, skipping that whole smelting bottleneck.”

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Proponents believe the potential for two open-pit mines that do not require the acid mine drainage, which can leave potentially toxic tailings behind, should make governments, the public and investors take note.

TURNING TO U.S. FOR FUNDING

The company is looking to secure between \$25-30 million to produce a feasibility study that could position the project for more significant investment.

First Atlantic has turned to the United States for possible funding to get the project to a stage where it can put shovels in the ground and commence construction.

It has been accepted into the United States Defense Industrial Base Consortium, a contracting vehicle administered by the Department of War to expand and sustain domestic industrial capacity, particularly where supply chains are fragile or overly dependent on foreign sources.

This week, the company is also participating in [SAFE Summit 2026](#) in Washington. SAFE is a

nonpartisan organization focused
on transportation, energy, and supply chain
policies that advance the economic and national
security of the United States and its allies.

first nickel

A drill core sample from First Atlantic Nickel's Pipestone
Ophiolite Complex in central Newfoundland gets a closer
examination. First Atlantic Nickel

SIMILAR PROJECT IN B.C.

First Atlantic Nickel compares its
central Newfoundland project to a high-grade
nickel play being pursued by FPX Nickel Corp. in
British Columbia.

A 2025 economic impact study for FPX's Baptiste
project indicated the mine would
contribute \$45.6 billion in total gross domestic
product and \$15.5 billion in direct, indirect and
indicted taxes across the country.

The project is estimated to have a 32-year
lifespan.

Smith said First Atlantic Nickel
has benefited from the awaruite processing
knowledge FPX has built up.

"We definitely benefited from all that
information, but we're doing it on our own," he

said. “We’re showing that it’s applicable here. We knew that it would be, but we (still) have to prove it.”



A drill core sample from First Atlantic Nickel's Pipestone Ophiolite Complex in central Newfoundland. First Atlantic Nickel

GETTING CAPITAL SUPPORT

Mining analyst Joe Mazumdar, editor and publisher of the industry newsletter

Exploration Insights, said First Atlantic's project, as well as FPX's, will ultimately hinge on market conditions, including price and demand.

“First Atlantic is a junior explorer working toward a resource at its Pipestone XL project in Newfoundland, a mining-friendly jurisdiction,” said Mazumdar. “It depends only on nickel market sentiment to encourage investors to fund its programs to discover a project like the feasibility-stage Baptiste in British Columbia, operated by FPX Nickel. The latter requires a higher nickel price much sooner to make its project economically viable.”

Smith said First Atlantic Nickel should have enough capital support from big players in the industry, including a strategic partner that the company would only confirm is from a G7

country, and from market support to finance more exploration and hopefully get that feasibility report done in the near term.

“But it would be a huge benefit to have \$20 million or \$30 million injected into the company in very good terms by a government entity that’s wanting to see these projects secured to deal with issues with the supply chain,” he said of potentially tapping into American funding sources.

First Atlantic announced Monday, April 27, that it is changing its name to First Atlantic Nickel and Cobalt on April 29 to better reflect the natural cobalt content of awaruite.



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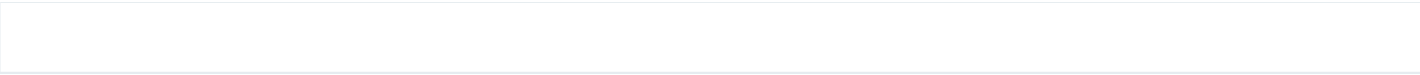
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